

COMPLETE CHESS LEARNING LIBRARY

Pawn and Minor-Piece Endgames

Opposition, races, bishops, knights, fortresses, and zugzwang

COURSE BOOK

20 focused chapters - model positions - decision rules - retrieval practice

Designed to change what you notice, calculate, remember, and do at the board.

How to Use This Course

ONE CHAPTER, FOUR PASSES

1. Read the position without moving pieces. 2. State your plan and the opponent's counterplay. 3. Study the decision rules. 4. Close the book and reconstruct the position from memory.

RETRIEVAL SCHEDULE

Review the chapter the next day, one week later, and after a game that reaches a similar structure. Retrieval is more valuable than rereading.

BOARD ROUTINE

Opponent's threat - forcing moves - loose pieces - worst piece - central break - best reply - choose and stop.

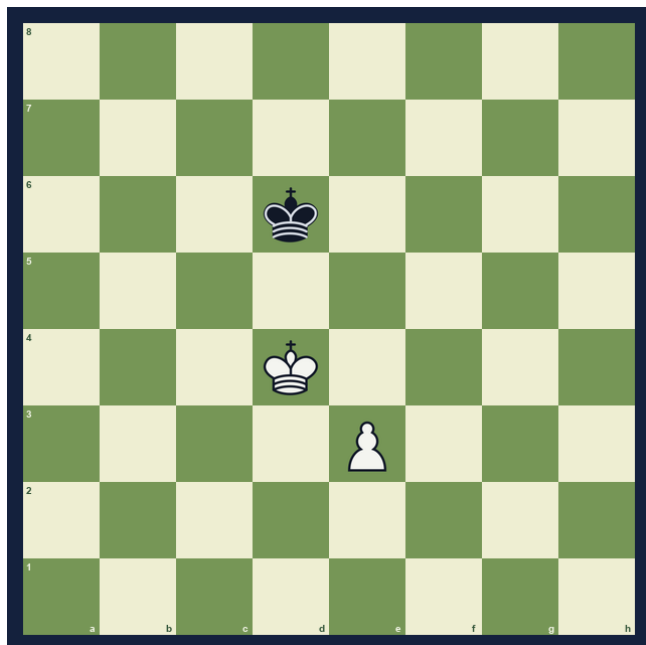
The course book explains each model position. The separate workbook forces recall, prediction, and self-scoring. Use the book first, then attempt the matching workbook page without looking back.

Engine evaluations are intentionally not the lesson. The aim is to store human decision rules that remain useful when the exact move order changes.

Course Map

MODULE	CHAPTERS
PAWN AND MINOR-PIECE ENDGAMES	20

01. Opposition



PAWN AND MINOR-PIECE ENDGAMES

READ THE POSITION

Control the key entry square by forcing the enemy king to yield.

PRIMARY PLAN

Identify the defender's best resource, map both king routes, and choose the move that preserves activity or the winning mechanism.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

The opponent seeks checks, king access, liquidation, a fortress, or a pawn race that changes the evaluation.

REFERENCE LINE

White to move - opposition study

MEMORY RULE

Control the key entry square by forcing the enemy king to yield.

01. Decision Framework

Opposition

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Calculate every forcing check, capture, pawn advance, and promotion tempo until the position becomes stable.
PIECE JOB	Place the king first, then position the rook or minor piece where it restricts the enemy king and supports the passer.
TACTICAL WARNING	Watch skewers, forks, rook sacrifices for the last pawn, promotion with check, and stalemate resources.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only after proving the resulting pawn ending or theoretical position.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Reconstruct the position from memory and state the winning or drawing mechanism without moving pieces.
CLOCK RULE	Use known theoretical landmarks to save time, then calculate the concrete exception.

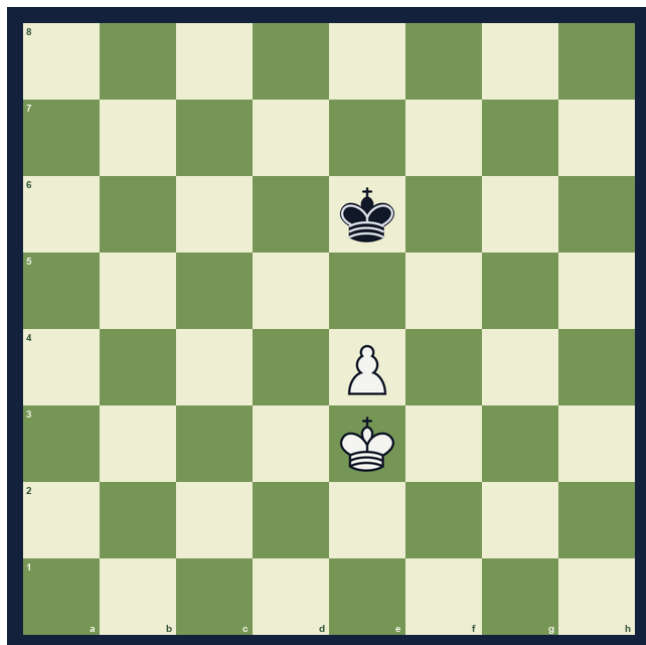
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Control the key entry square by forcing the enemy king to yield.

02. Distant Opposition



PAWN AND MINOR-PIECE ENDGAMES

READ THE POSITION

Use the parity of squares to preserve the opposition from farther away.

PRIMARY PLAN

Identify the defender's best resource, map both king routes, and choose the move that preserves activity or the winning mechanism.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

The opponent seeks checks, king access, liquidation, a fortress, or a pawn race that changes the evaluation.

REFERENCE LINE

White to move - key-square study

MEMORY RULE

Use the parity of squares to preserve the opposition from farther away.

02. Decision Framework

Distant Opposition

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Calculate every forcing check, capture, pawn advance, and promotion tempo until the position becomes stable.
PIECE JOB	Place the king first, then position the rook or minor piece where it restricts the enemy king and supports the passer.
TACTICAL WARNING	Watch skewers, forks, rook sacrifices for the last pawn, promotion with check, and stalemate resources.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only after proving the resulting pawn ending or theoretical position.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Reconstruct the position from memory and state the winning or drawing mechanism without moving pieces.
CLOCK RULE	Use known theoretical landmarks to save time, then calculate the concrete exception.

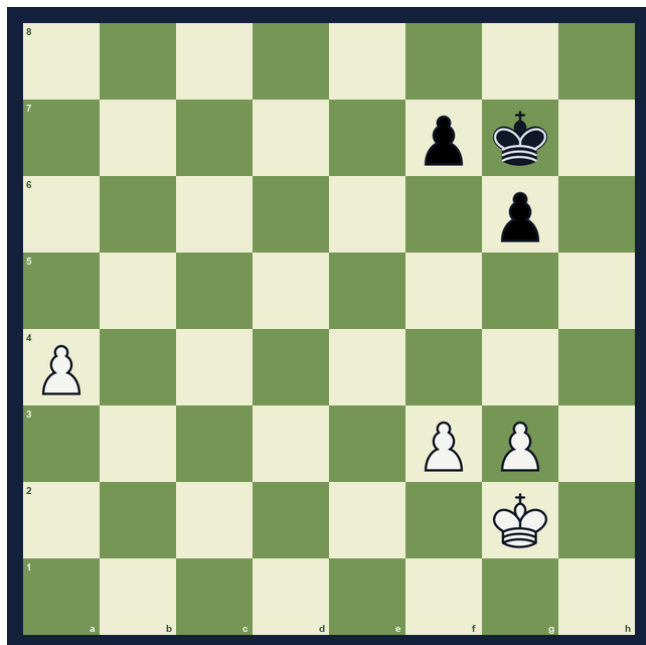
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Use the parity of squares to preserve the opposition from farther away.

03. Corresponding Squares



PAWN AND MINOR-PIECE ENDGAMES

READ THE POSITION

Some king positions are linked: entering one square forces the opponent into the matching square.

PRIMARY PLAN

Identify the defender's best resource, map both king routes, and choose the move that preserves activity or the winning mechanism.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

The opponent seeks checks, king access, liquidation, a fortress, or a pawn race that changes the evaluation.

REFERENCE LINE

White to move - create a diversion

MEMORY RULE

Some king positions are linked: entering one square forces the opponent into the matching square.

03. Decision Framework

Corresponding Squares

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Calculate every forcing check, capture, pawn advance, and promotion tempo until the position becomes stable.
PIECE JOB	Place the king first, then position the rook or minor piece where it restricts the enemy king and supports the passer.
TACTICAL WARNING	Watch skewers, forks, rook sacrifices for the last pawn, promotion with check, and stalemate resources.
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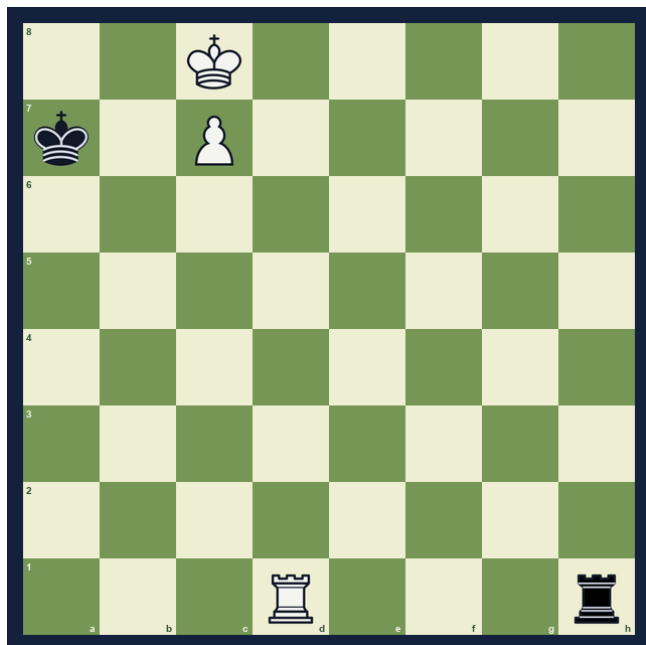
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1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Some king positions are linked: entering one square forces the opponent into the matching square.

04. Key Squares



PAWN AND MINOR-PIECE ENDGAMES

READ THE POSITION

A pawn wins when its king reaches the correct key squares ahead of it.

PRIMARY PLAN

Identify the defender's best resource, map both king routes, and choose the move that preserves activity or the winning mechanism.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

The opponent seeks checks, king access, liquidation, a fortress, or a pawn race that changes the evaluation.

REFERENCE LINE

White to move - Lucena-type position

MEMORY RULE

A pawn wins when its king reaches the correct key squares ahead of it.

04. Decision Framework

Key Squares

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Calculate every forcing check, capture, pawn advance, and promotion tempo until the position becomes stable.
PIECE JOB	Place the king first, then position the rook or minor piece where it restricts the enemy king and supports the passer.
TACTICAL WARNING	Watch skewers, forks, rook sacrifices for the last pawn, promotion with check, and stalemate resources.
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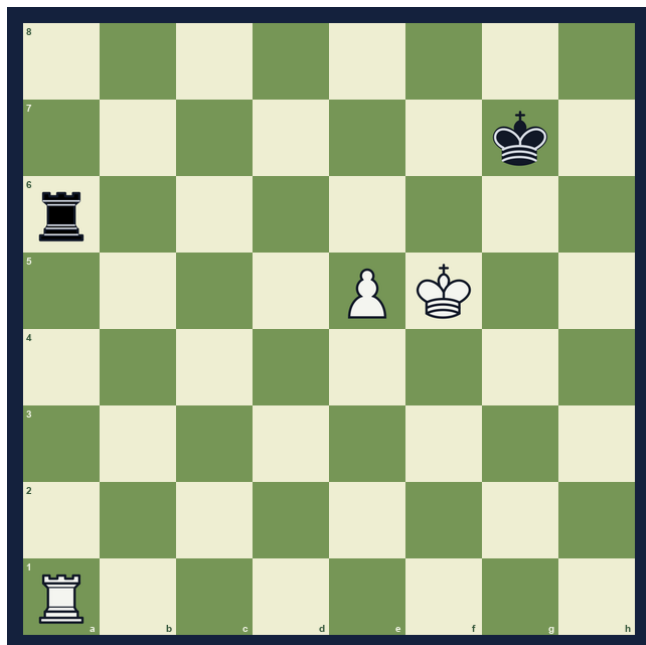
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2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: A pawn wins when its king reaches the correct key squares ahead of it.

05. Reserve Tempi



PAWN AND MINOR-PIECE ENDGAMES

READ THE POSITION

A spare pawn move can transfer the move and decide a king maneuver.

PRIMARY PLAN

Identify the defender's best resource, map both king routes, and choose the move that preserves activity or the winning mechanism.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

The opponent seeks checks, king access, liquidation, a fortress, or a pawn race that changes the evaluation.

REFERENCE LINE

Black to move - Philidor-type defense

MEMORY RULE

A spare pawn move can transfer the move and decide a king maneuver.

05. Decision Framework

Reserve Tempi

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Calculate every forcing check, capture, pawn advance, and promotion tempo until the position becomes stable.
PIECE JOB	Place the king first, then position the rook or minor piece where it restricts the enemy king and supports the passer.
TACTICAL WARNING	Watch skewers, forks, rook sacrifices for the last pawn, promotion with check, and stalemate resources.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only after proving the resulting pawn ending or theoretical position.
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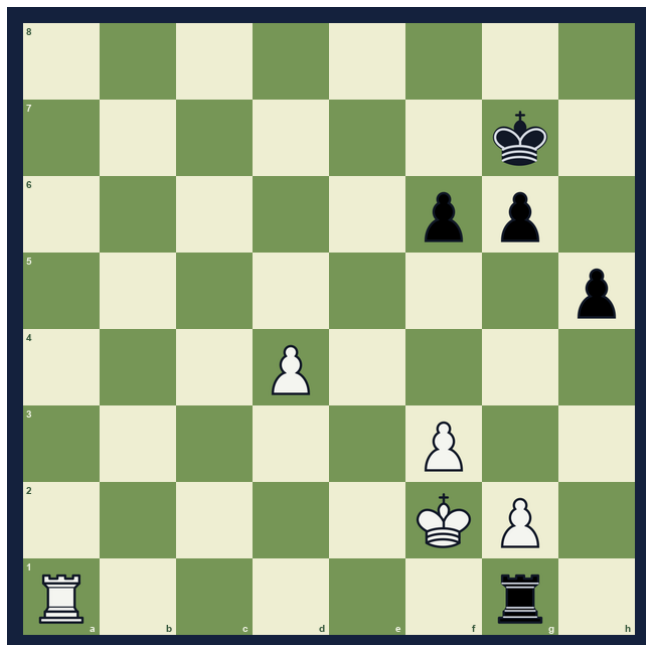
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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: A spare pawn move can transfer the move and decide a king maneuver.

06. Outside Passed Pawn



PAWN AND MINOR-PIECE ENDGAMES

READ THE POSITION

Create a distant passer to divert the king from the other wing.

PRIMARY PLAN

Identify the defender's best resource, map both king routes, and choose the move that preserves activity or the winning mechanism.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

The opponent seeks checks, king access, liquidation, a fortress, or a pawn race that changes the evaluation.

REFERENCE LINE

White to move - activity over passivity

MEMORY RULE

Create a distant passer to divert the king from the other wing.

06. Decision Framework

Outside Passed Pawn

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Calculate every forcing check, capture, pawn advance, and promotion tempo until the position becomes stable.
PIECE JOB	Place the king first, then position the rook or minor piece where it restricts the enemy king and supports the passer.
TACTICAL WARNING	Watch skewers, forks, rook sacrifices for the last pawn, promotion with check, and stalemate resources.
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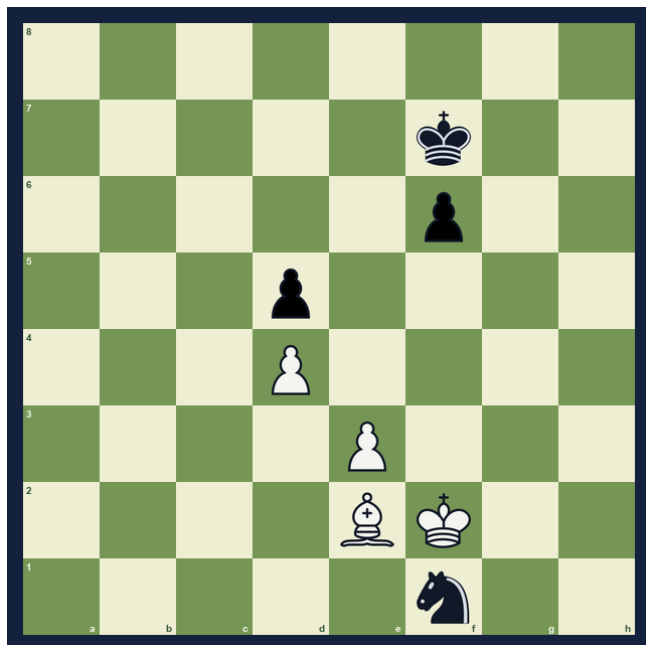
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3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Create a distant passer to divert the king from the other wing.

07. Protected Passed Pawn



PAWN AND MINOR-PIECE ENDGAMES

READ THE POSITION

A protected passer restricts the king even when it cannot advance immediately.

PRIMARY PLAN

Identify the defender's best resource, map both king routes, and choose the move that preserves activity or the winning mechanism.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

The opponent seeks checks, king access, liquidation, a fortress, or a pawn race that changes the evaluation.

REFERENCE LINE

White to move - minor-piece evaluation

MEMORY RULE

A protected passer restricts the king even when it cannot advance immediately.

07. Decision Framework

Protected Passed Pawn

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Calculate every forcing check, capture, pawn advance, and promotion tempo until the position becomes stable.
PIECE JOB	Place the king first, then position the rook or minor piece where it restricts the enemy king and supports the passer.
TACTICAL WARNING	Watch skewers, forks, rook sacrifices for the last pawn, promotion with check, and stalemate resources.
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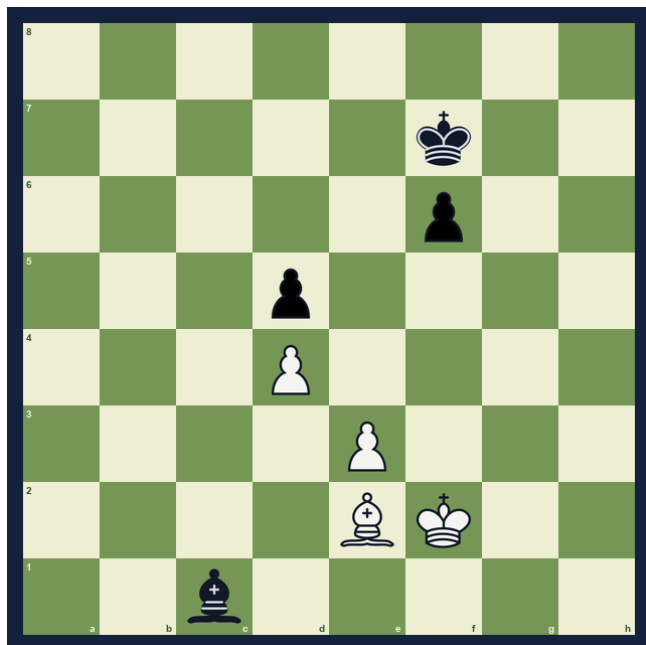
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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: A protected passer restricts the king even when it cannot advance immediately.

08. Pawn Breakthrough



PAWN AND MINOR-PIECE ENDGAMES

READ THE POSITION

Sacrifice pawns to create a passer whose promotion tempo cannot be met.

PRIMARY PLAN

Identify the defender's best resource, map both king routes, and choose the move that preserves activity or the winning mechanism.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

The opponent seeks checks, king access, liquidation, a fortress, or a pawn race that changes the evaluation.

REFERENCE LINE

White to move - fortress and passer study

MEMORY RULE

Sacrifice pawns to create a passer whose promotion tempo cannot be met.

08. Decision Framework

Pawn Breakthrough

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Calculate every forcing check, capture, pawn advance, and promotion tempo until the position becomes stable.
PIECE JOB	Place the king first, then position the rook or minor piece where it restricts the enemy king and supports the passer.
TACTICAL WARNING	Watch skewers, forks, rook sacrifices for the last pawn, promotion with check, and stalemate resources.
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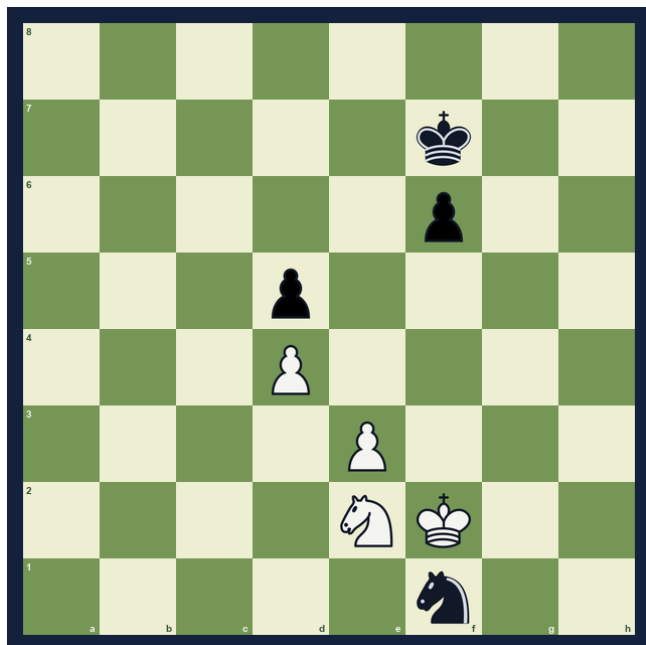
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3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Sacrifice pawns to create a passer whose promotion tempo cannot be met.

09. Pawn Race Calculation



PAWN AND MINOR-PIECE ENDGAMES

READ THE POSITION

Count moves, checks, promotion with tempo, and whether the new queen controls the other promotion square.

PRIMARY PLAN

Identify the defender's best resource, map both king routes, and choose the move that preserves activity or the winning mechanism.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

The opponent seeks checks, king access, liquidation, a fortress, or a pawn race that changes the evaluation.

REFERENCE LINE

White to move - king and knight activity

MEMORY RULE

Count moves, checks, promotion with tempo, and whether the new queen controls the other promotion square.

09. Decision Framework

Pawn Race Calculation

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Calculate every forcing check, capture, pawn advance, and promotion tempo until the position becomes stable.
PIECE JOB	Place the king first, then position the rook or minor piece where it restricts the enemy king and supports the passer.
TACTICAL WARNING	Watch skewers, forks, rook sacrifices for the last pawn, promotion with check, and stalemate resources.
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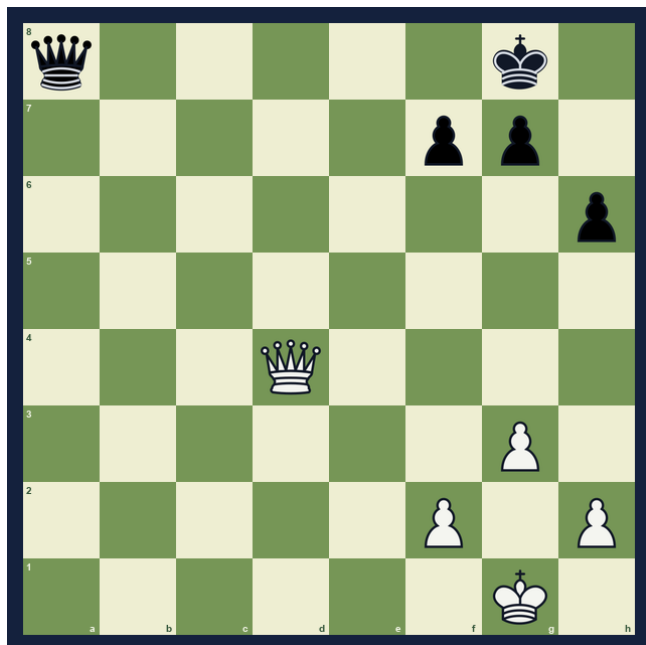
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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Count moves, checks, promotion with tempo, and whether the new queen controls the other promotion square.

10. Bishop Versus Knight



PAWN AND MINOR-PIECE ENDGAMES

READ THE POSITION

Judge the pieces by pawn placement, targets, and available outposts.

PRIMARY PLAN

Identify the defender's best resource, map both king routes, and choose the move that preserves activity or the winning mechanism.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

The opponent seeks checks, king access, liquidation, a fortress, or a pawn race that changes the evaluation.

REFERENCE LINE

White to move - checks and king shelter

MEMORY RULE

Judge the pieces by pawn placement, targets, and available outposts.

10. Decision Framework

Bishop Versus Knight

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Calculate every forcing check, capture, pawn advance, and promotion tempo until the position becomes stable.
PIECE JOB	Place the king first, then position the rook or minor piece where it restricts the enemy king and supports the passer.
TACTICAL WARNING	Watch skewers, forks, rook sacrifices for the last pawn, promotion with check, and stalemate resources.
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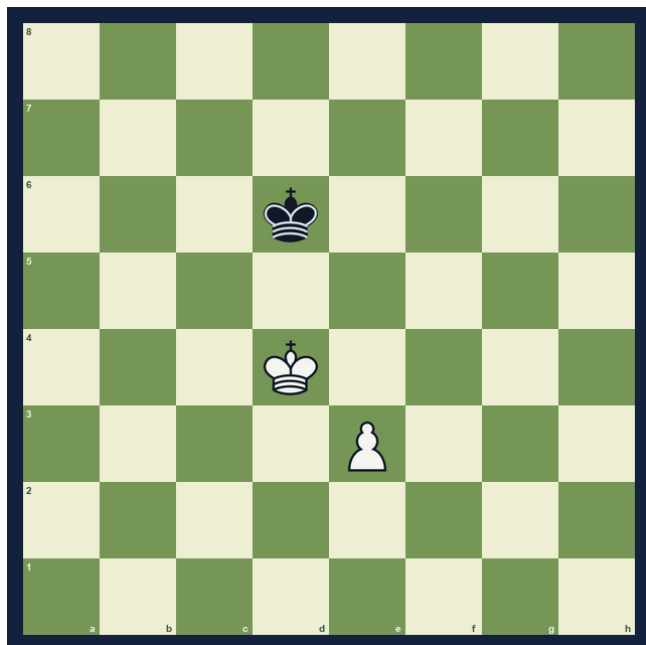
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3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Judge the pieces by pawn placement, targets, and available outposts.

11. Good and Bad Bishops



PAWN AND MINOR-PIECE ENDGAMES

READ THE POSITION

A bishop is bad when its own fixed pawns restrict its useful diagonals.

PRIMARY PLAN

Identify the defender's best resource, map both king routes, and choose the move that preserves activity or the winning mechanism.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

The opponent seeks checks, king access, liquidation, a fortress, or a pawn race that changes the evaluation.

REFERENCE LINE

White to move - opposition study

MEMORY RULE

A bishop is bad when its own fixed pawns restrict its useful diagonals.

11. Decision Framework

Good and Bad Bishops

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Calculate every forcing check, capture, pawn advance, and promotion tempo until the position becomes stable.
PIECE JOB	Place the king first, then position the rook or minor piece where it restricts the enemy king and supports the passer.
TACTICAL WARNING	Watch skewers, forks, rook sacrifices for the last pawn, promotion with check, and stalemate resources.
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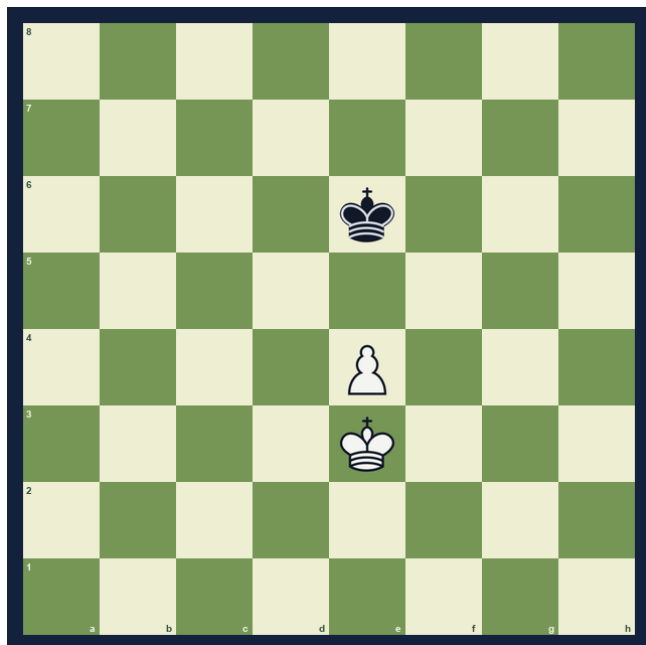
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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: A bishop is bad when its own fixed pawns restrict its useful diagonals.

12. Opposite-Colored Bishops



PAWN AND MINOR-PIECE ENDGAMES

READ THE POSITION

The attacker uses a second weakness; the defender seeks a blockade and fortress.

PRIMARY PLAN

Identify the defender's best resource, map both king routes, and choose the move that preserves activity or the winning mechanism.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

The opponent seeks checks, king access, liquidation, a fortress, or a pawn race that changes the evaluation.

REFERENCE LINE

White to move - key-square study

MEMORY RULE

The attacker uses a second weakness; the defender seeks a blockade and fortress.

12. Decision Framework

Opposite-Colored Bishops

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Calculate every forcing check, capture, pawn advance, and promotion tempo until the position becomes stable.
PIECE JOB	Place the king first, then position the rook or minor piece where it restricts the enemy king and supports the passer.
TACTICAL WARNING	Watch skewers, forks, rook sacrifices for the last pawn, promotion with check, and stalemate resources.
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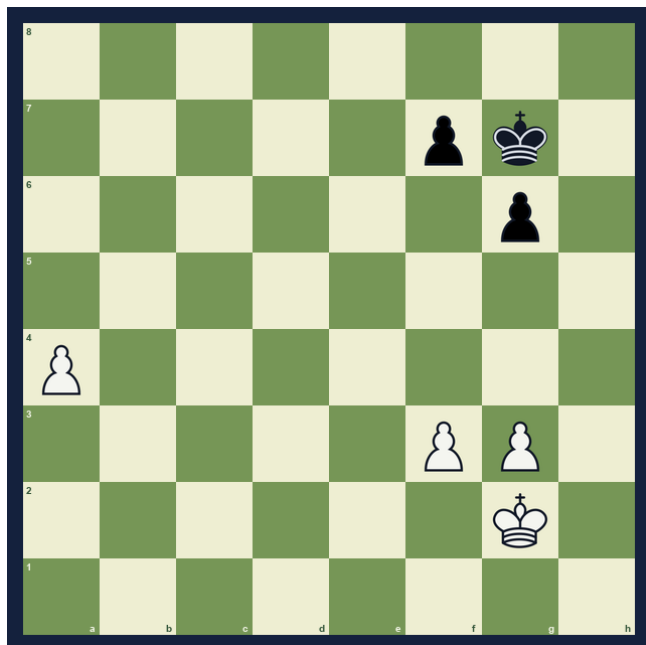
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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: The attacker uses a second weakness; the defender seeks a blockade and fortress.

13. Same-Colored Bishops



PAWN AND MINOR-PIECE ENDGAMES

READ THE POSITION

King activity and penetration on the bishop's color often decide the ending.

PRIMARY PLAN

Identify the defender's best resource, map both king routes, and choose the move that preserves activity or the winning mechanism.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

The opponent seeks checks, king access, liquidation, a fortress, or a pawn race that changes the evaluation.

REFERENCE LINE

White to move - create a diversion

MEMORY RULE

King activity and penetration on the bishop's color often decide the ending.

13. Decision Framework

Same-Colored Bishops

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Calculate every forcing check, capture, pawn advance, and promotion tempo until the position becomes stable.
PIECE JOB	Place the king first, then position the rook or minor piece where it restricts the enemy king and supports the passer.
TACTICAL WARNING	Watch skewers, forks, rook sacrifices for the last pawn, promotion with check, and stalemate resources.
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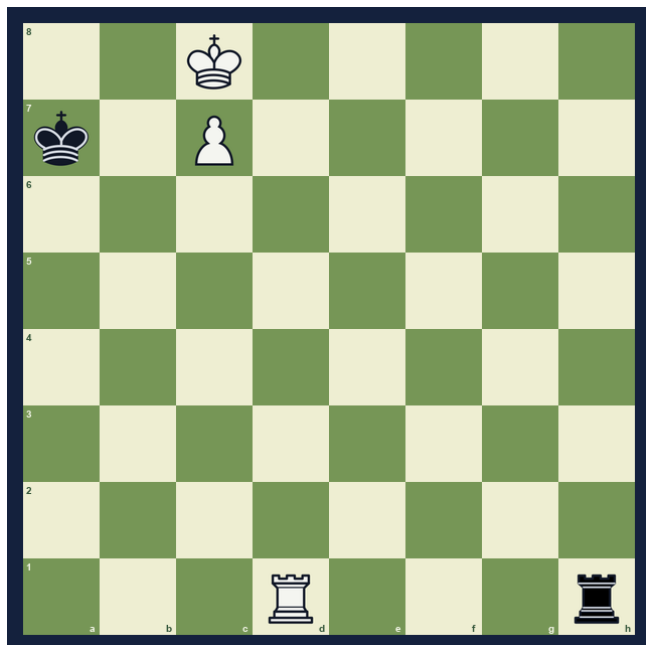
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5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: King activity and penetration on the bishop's color often decide the ending.

14. Knight Outposts



PAWN AND MINOR-PIECE ENDGAMES

READ THE POSITION

A knight needs a stable square and reachable targets, not merely a protected post.

PRIMARY PLAN

Identify the defender's best resource, map both king routes, and choose the move that preserves activity or the winning mechanism.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

The opponent seeks checks, king access, liquidation, a fortress, or a pawn race that changes the evaluation.

REFERENCE LINE

White to move - Lucena-type position

MEMORY RULE

A knight needs a stable square and reachable targets, not merely a protected post.

14. Decision Framework

Knight Outposts

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Calculate every forcing check, capture, pawn advance, and promotion tempo until the position becomes stable.
PIECE JOB	Place the king first, then position the rook or minor piece where it restricts the enemy king and supports the passer.
TACTICAL WARNING	Watch skewers, forks, rook sacrifices for the last pawn, promotion with check, and stalemate resources.
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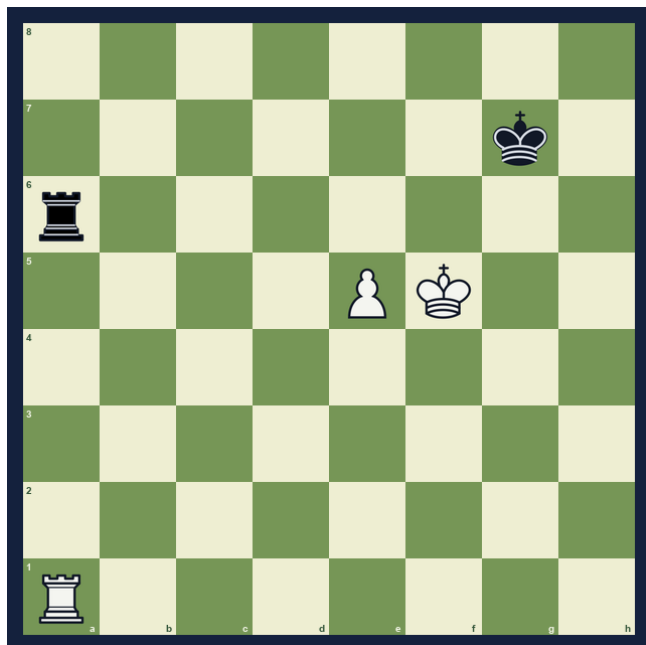
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5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: A knight needs a stable square and reachable targets, not merely a protected post.

15. Knight Versus Pawns on Both Wings



PAWN AND MINOR-PIECE ENDGAMES

READ THE POSITION

The knight may struggle to switch wings; create play on both sides.

PRIMARY PLAN

Identify the defender's best resource, map both king routes, and choose the move that preserves activity or the winning mechanism.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

The opponent seeks checks, king access, liquidation, a fortress, or a pawn race that changes the evaluation.

REFERENCE LINE

Black to move - Philidor-type defense

MEMORY RULE

The knight may struggle to switch wings; create play on both sides.

15. Decision Framework

Knight Versus Pawns on Both Wings

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Calculate every forcing check, capture, pawn advance, and promotion tempo until the position becomes stable.
PIECE JOB	Place the king first, then position the rook or minor piece where it restricts the enemy king and supports the passer.
TACTICAL WARNING	Watch skewers, forks, rook sacrifices for the last pawn, promotion with check, and stalemate resources.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only after proving the resulting pawn ending or theoretical position.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Reconstruct the position from memory and state the winning or drawing mechanism without moving pieces.
CLOCK RULE	Use known theoretical landmarks to save time, then calculate the concrete exception.

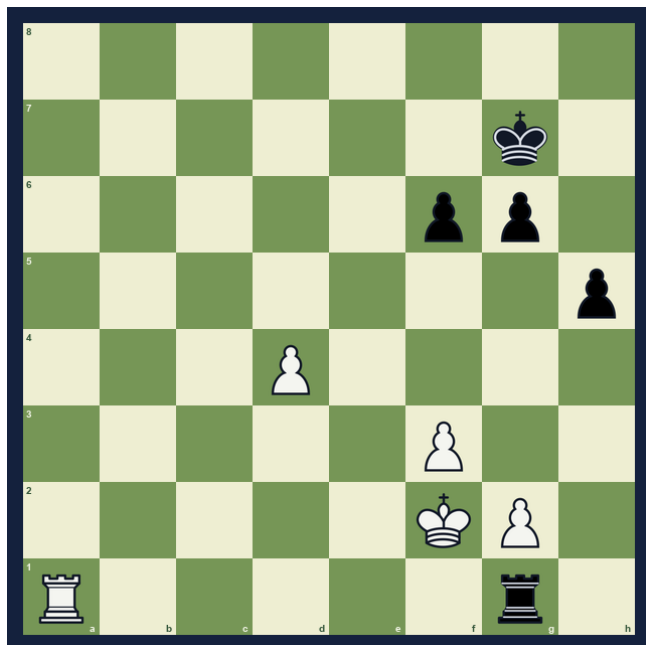
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: The knight may struggle to switch wings; create play on both sides.

16. Bishop and Outside Passer



PAWN AND MINOR-PIECE ENDGAMES

READ THE POSITION

Use the bishop's long range to support one wing while the king attacks the other.

PRIMARY PLAN

Identify the defender's best resource, map both king routes, and choose the move that preserves activity or the winning mechanism.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

The opponent seeks checks, king access, liquidation, a fortress, or a pawn race that changes the evaluation.

REFERENCE LINE

White to move - activity over passivity

MEMORY RULE

Use the bishop's long range to support one wing while the king attacks the other.

16. Decision Framework

Bishop and Outside Passer

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Calculate every forcing check, capture, pawn advance, and promotion tempo until the position becomes stable.
PIECE JOB	Place the king first, then position the rook or minor piece where it restricts the enemy king and supports the passer.
TACTICAL WARNING	Watch skewers, forks, rook sacrifices for the last pawn, promotion with check, and stalemate resources.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only after proving the resulting pawn ending or theoretical position.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Reconstruct the position from memory and state the winning or drawing mechanism without moving pieces.
CLOCK RULE	Use known theoretical landmarks to save time, then calculate the concrete exception.

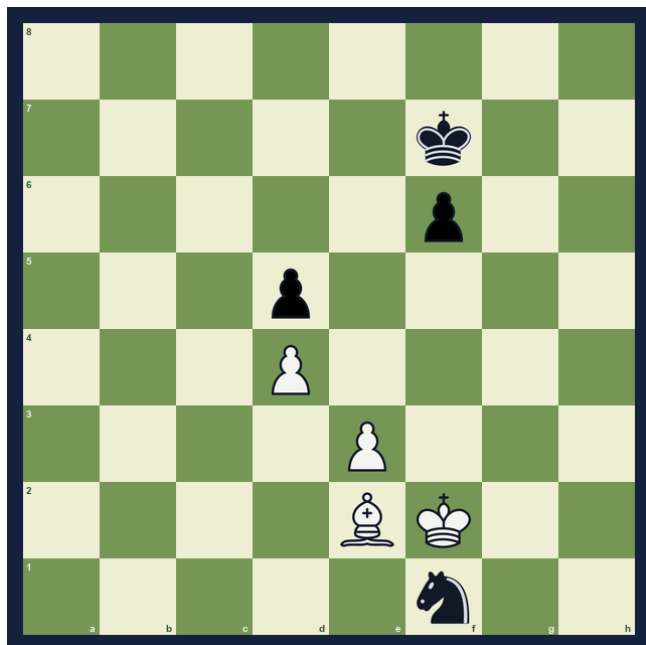
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Use the bishop's long range to support one wing while the king attacks the other.

17. Minor-Piece Exchange



PAWN AND MINOR-PIECE ENDGAMES

READ THE POSITION

Trade into a pawn ending only after calculating king access and reserve tempi.

PRIMARY PLAN

Identify the defender's best resource, map both king routes, and choose the move that preserves activity or the winning mechanism.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

The opponent seeks checks, king access, liquidation, a fortress, or a pawn race that changes the evaluation.

REFERENCE LINE

White to move - minor-piece evaluation

MEMORY RULE

Trade into a pawn ending only after calculating king access and reserve tempi.

17. Decision Framework

Minor-Piece Exchange

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Calculate every forcing check, capture, pawn advance, and promotion tempo until the position becomes stable.
PIECE JOB	Place the king first, then position the rook or minor piece where it restricts the enemy king and supports the passer.
TACTICAL WARNING	Watch skewers, forks, rook sacrifices for the last pawn, promotion with check, and stalemate resources.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only after proving the resulting pawn ending or theoretical position.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Reconstruct the position from memory and state the winning or drawing mechanism without moving pieces.
CLOCK RULE	Use known theoretical landmarks to save time, then calculate the concrete exception.

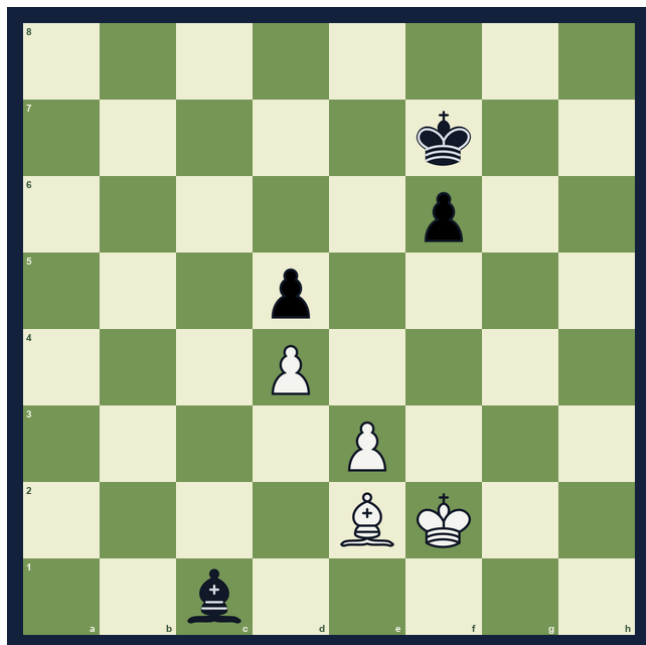
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Trade into a pawn ending only after calculating king access and reserve tempi.

18. Fortress Recognition



PAWN AND MINOR-PIECE ENDGAMES

READ THE POSITION

Stop pushing when every transformation destroys the only defensive setup.

PRIMARY PLAN

Identify the defender's best resource, map both king routes, and choose the move that preserves activity or the winning mechanism.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

The opponent seeks checks, king access, liquidation, a fortress, or a pawn race that changes the evaluation.

REFERENCE LINE

White to move - fortress and passer study

MEMORY RULE

Stop pushing when every transformation destroys the only defensive setup.

18. Decision Framework

Fortress Recognition

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Calculate every forcing check, capture, pawn advance, and promotion tempo until the position becomes stable.
PIECE JOB	Place the king first, then position the rook or minor piece where it restricts the enemy king and supports the passer.
TACTICAL WARNING	Watch skewers, forks, rook sacrifices for the last pawn, promotion with check, and stalemate resources.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only after proving the resulting pawn ending or theoretical position.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Reconstruct the position from memory and state the winning or drawing mechanism without moving pieces.
CLOCK RULE	Use known theoretical landmarks to save time, then calculate the concrete exception.

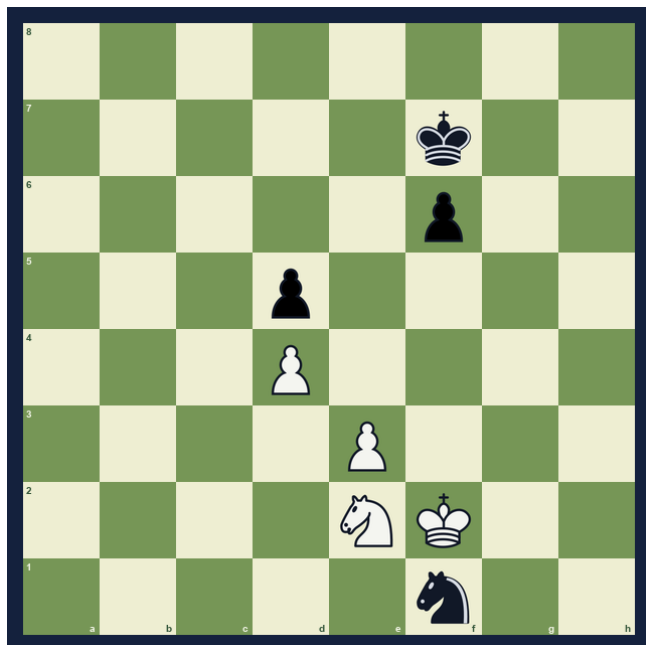
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Stop pushing when every transformation destroys the only defensive setup.

19. Zugzwang



PAWN AND MINOR-PIECE ENDGAMES

READ THE POSITION

Improve the position until every legal move worsens the opponent's setup.

PRIMARY PLAN

Identify the defender's best resource, map both king routes, and choose the move that preserves activity or the winning mechanism.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

The opponent seeks checks, king access, liquidation, a fortress, or a pawn race that changes the evaluation.

REFERENCE LINE

White to move - king and knight activity

MEMORY RULE

Improve the position until every legal move worsens the opponent's setup.

19. Decision Framework

Zugzwang

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Calculate every forcing check, capture, pawn advance, and promotion tempo until the position becomes stable.
PIECE JOB	Place the king first, then position the rook or minor piece where it restricts the enemy king and supports the passer.
TACTICAL WARNING	Watch skewers, forks, rook sacrifices for the last pawn, promotion with check, and stalemate resources.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only after proving the resulting pawn ending or theoretical position.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Reconstruct the position from memory and state the winning or drawing mechanism without moving pieces.
CLOCK RULE	Use known theoretical landmarks to save time, then calculate the concrete exception.

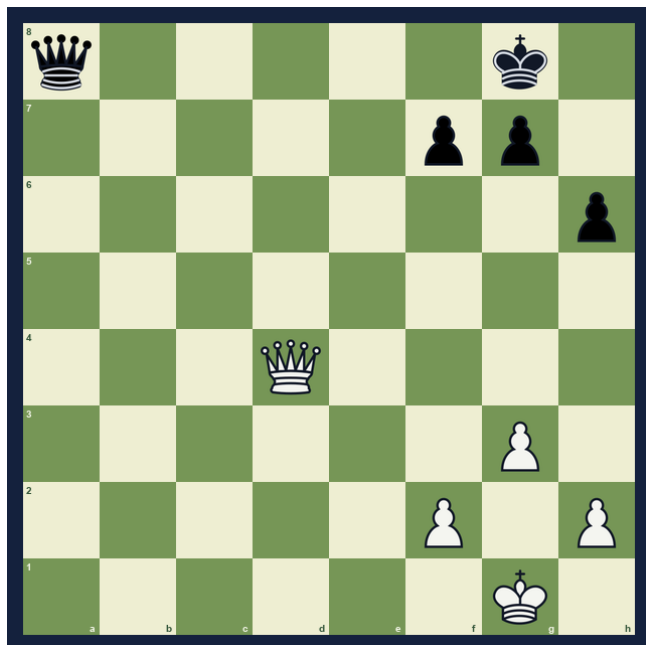
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Improve the position until every legal move worsens the opponent's setup.

20. Endgame Calculation Routine



PAWN AND MINOR-PIECE ENDGAMES

READ THE POSITION

Map king routes, forcing captures, pawn races, and the final promotion square.

PRIMARY PLAN

Identify the defender's best resource, map both king routes, and choose the move that preserves activity or the winning mechanism.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

The opponent seeks checks, king access, liquidation, a fortress, or a pawn race that changes the evaluation.

REFERENCE LINE

White to move - checks and king shelter

MEMORY RULE

Map king routes, forcing captures, pawn races, and the final promotion square.

20. Decision Framework

Endgame Calculation Routine

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Calculate every forcing check, capture, pawn advance, and promotion tempo until the position becomes stable.
PIECE JOB	Place the king first, then position the rook or minor piece where it restricts the enemy king and supports the passer.
TACTICAL WARNING	Watch skewers, forks, rook sacrifices for the last pawn, promotion with check, and stalemate resources.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only after proving the resulting pawn ending or theoretical position.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Reconstruct the position from memory and state the winning or drawing mechanism without moving pieces.
CLOCK RULE	Use known theoretical landmarks to save time, then calculate the concrete exception.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Map king routes, forcing captures, pawn races, and the final promotion square.

Course Completion Test

Choose ten chapters at random. Rebuild each reference position, name both sides' plans, identify the critical break, and state the trade filter without reopening the chapter.

Score one point for the structure, one for your plan, one for counterplay, one for the break, and one for the memory rule. Forty out of fifty means the knowledge is usable; below forty means retrieval practice should continue.

FINAL PRINCIPLE

A course is complete when its ideas appear in your decisions, not when its pages have been read.